

TheFAB's Homemade Bolognese

Slow cooking at its finest. Fresh tomatoes, fragrant sage, rich broth and hours of patience transform simple ingredients into a sauce that tastes like home. This is the kind of Bolognese that brings everyone back to the table for seconds.

Ingredients

- 600 g minced beef (15–20% fat ideal)
- 800 g ripe fresh tomatoes, roughly chopped (or 2 x 400 g tins)
- 1 large onion, finely diced
- 2 carrots, finely diced
- 2 celery stalks, finely diced
- 4 cloves garlic, sliced
- 6 fresh sage leaves
- 1 small bunch fresh rosemary
- 150 ml dry red wine
- 250 ml beef or veal broth
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Salt and black pepper

Method

1. Heat olive oil in a heavy-based pot over medium-high heat. Add the onion, carrot and celery. Cook gently for 10 minutes until soft.
2. Add the garlic, sage and rosemary. Cook for 2 more minutes.
3. Increase heat to high. Add the mince and break it up well. Cook until properly browned — do not rush this step.
4. Pour in the wine. Let it bubble and reduce completely, about 3 minutes.
5. Add the tomatoes and broth. Season generously with salt and pepper.
6. Bring to a boil, then reduce to the lowest simmer possible. Cover partially.
7. Cook for 2.5 to 3 hours, stirring every 30 minutes. The sauce should be thick, dark and fragrant.
8. Adjust seasoning before serving. Best with tagliatelle or pappardelle.